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A tale from the Czluchow woods

INTERNATIONAL UFO REPORTER

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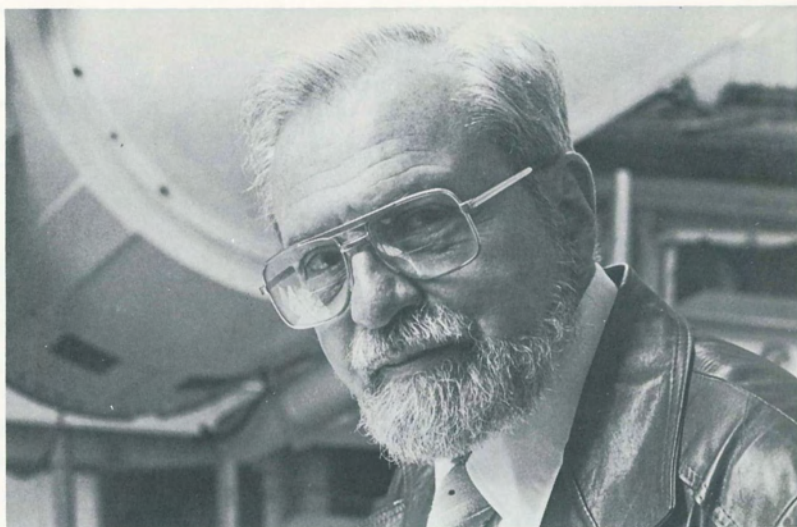
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We work in the brilliant spotlight of the present, only dimly conscious of the penumbra of the past and quite unable to illuminate the darkness of the future.... But there will surely be, we hope, a 21st-Century science and a 30th-Century science, and perhaps they will encompass the UFO phenomenon as 20th-Century science has encompassed the aurora borealis, a feat unimaginable to 19th-Century science....

J. Allen Hynek

1910 - 1986

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EDITORIAL

UFOs: still here, sort of

From time to time we get letters from readers who complain that we are not publishing material on recent sightings. The writers seem to feel that we have made a conscious editorial decision not to publish new case material.

Not so. All of us involved with *IUR* would be delighted to devote a significant portion of each issue to interesting, well-documented new sightings. The reason we haven't done so is simple. As I wrote in my first *IUR* editorial a year ago, "Since 1947 there has never been a period that has seen so little UFO activity." Those who doubt that are urged, as one easy method of verifying my allegation, to consult Lucius Farish's monthly *UFO Newsclipping Service*, wherein you will see that most newspaper articles these days are about UFO buffs, not UFO sightings.

The strange fact of the matter -- and it may be the most important development on the UFO scene since the early flaps of the late 1940s -- is that UFOs are a lot less with us than they have been in a long time. A respected historian of the UFO phenomenon will argue, in an essay to appear in an upcoming issue, that the age of the great UFO waves is past. That does not mean there is no longer any UFO activity, just that it's noticeably less frequent than anything we were used to prior to the 1980s.

Things, in short, are quiet. If we were paranoids, we would say (as they used to say in B movies) they're *too* quiet. Not being paranoids, we have concluded that, if UFO activity is not undergoing a temporary (though already unusually long) lull, then the UFO phenomenon is changing in some way. If there are UFOs, the intelligences operating them are doing something different from what they did between the 1940s and the late 1970s. If there are no UFOs, then whatever social forces caused people to believe they were there have changed, or at least are being manifested in other ways.



Jerome Clark

All that said, however, we are pleased to have an issue devoted almost entirely to case material, as a way of compensating for the relative scarcity of same in recent issues. And as we were putting this issue together, we received manuscripts (courtesy of Bob Boyd, head of CUFOS' investigative network) detailing incidents reported and documented in late 1985 and early 1986. These are scheduled for publication as soon as space permits.

This issue contains Jenny Randles' examination of a small British flap in April 1984, with, Randles suggests, implications for the future -- among other things a major European wave in 1987. (If it happens, remember you read it here first.) Bronislaw Rzepecki reviews the Polish UFO and ufological scene, showing that both UFOs and ufologists are much the same everywhere.

The most unusual case, however, is the one detailed by longtime California ufologist Ann Druffel, who (like me) is interested in the contactee phenomenon. (Contactees, as distinct from abductees, are persons who believe they are in continuing contact with benevolent "Space Brothers.") Druffel does not believe that contactees are *really* talking with extraterrestrials; as she points out, there is no especially compelling need to go beyond psychological explanations (albeit very *interesting* psychological explanations) in these cases.

Nonetheless, from time to time sober investigators have had unusual experiences in the company of contactees and Druffel, with all appropriate caution, reports one of these. She does not conclude, and neither do we, that the experience validates the empirical existence of long-winded New Age philosophers from the outer galaxies. But what the experience *does* mean is a question that for the moment can only be raised, not answered. -- Jerome Clark

Anatomy of a UFO wave

by Jenny Randles

Jenny Randles, *IUR* contributing editor and director of investigations for the British UFO Research Association, is the author, most recently, of *Science and the UFOs* (1985), written with Peter Warrington. She edits *Northern UFO News*.

I do not have a great deal of faith in so-called UFO cycles. Over the years UFO theorists have attempted to correlate sightings with the position of Mars, sunspot activity, earthquakes -- you name it. But nothing consistently works. If there is a periodicity which works, we can mobilize our limited resources and be ready next time.

It is as easy to see UFO waves in the statistical jungle as it is to spot fairies in the embers of a fire. At least so I thought, until I made an apparently successful prediction.

My book *The Pennine UFO Mystery* (Grafton Books, London) was published in July 1983. It is essentially an account of an abduction experience claimed by Yorkshire police officer Alan Godfrey in November 1980 and the (allegedly) associated mystery death of a local miner who had the curious last name of Adamski. In researching the background to this complex inter-related affair, however, I uncovered a surprising wealth of material associated with this moorland area of *Wuthering Heights* fame. In the end I devoted more than half my book to the events in the region before and after the Godfrey and Adamski incidents.

One of the things that leaped out at me from this material was a 21-month cycle in the reports. The starting point was November 1980 (when PC Alan Godfrey had his encounter). There were many other close encounters round this time, especially within a 10-day spell. Working backwards through the data to 1975 (when my files begin), I could easily show that peaks of activity centered on August 1975, May 1977 (Britain's biggest ever month for sightings) and February 1979. The 21-month date after November 1980, July-August 1982, had also been rich in reports.

All of these times showed an upsurge in UFO reports throughout Britain and the rise in the Pennines was simply an associated spin-off. But it is unmistakable. Not only were there more reports then, but the caliber was unusually high, many close encounters crammed into a small space of time. Yet I was still unsure of myself. I know that the only true test was to make a prediction in print and stand or fall by it. The July-August prediction was made in 1982, before it happened; the book had gone to press before then. But obviously I cannot prove that. April 1984 was nine months after the book hit the shops, though, and so it certainly a fair test.

Frankly, UFO reports in 1984 were at an all-time low. The British UFO Research Association (BUFORA) has just 23 cases on file for the entire year even two years later. So the chances of my cycle's being noticeable seemed slim. In fact I quite forgot about it, being totally wrapped up in the Rendlesham Forest saga for much of 1984. Then, when I sat down to work out the statistics for the year a few months ago, I realized what had happened. Somehow (I don't know how) my prediction had come true.

Any typical 10-day period in 1984 ought to contain 1/36th of the total reports for the year. Which, as you can see, would be less than one. But the period April 15 to 25 contains no fewer than five -- around a quarter of the entire year's total! As to my comment about close-encounter status of the cases, you may judge this from the summaries that follow. I can assure you that there are almost no other 1984 reports that come close to these in strangeness.

April 15, 1984 00.00 hrs. (all times are British Standard Time) Location: Llangernyw, North Wales

This village is the main habitation center (of a few hundred persons) in a rural and hilly area of the Snowdonia National Park, about 10 miles inland from the town of Llandrillo. It consists mostly of sheep farms. It is also close to a village

called Llandrillo where a peculiar "UFO crash" occurred in January 1974, leading to an entire mountain's being cordoned off while search operations proceeded under military supervision.

Several local farm workers observed the events, just before midnight, because it was lambing season and they were out late in their fields. Investigator Margaret Fry tracked down quite a number and obtained statements and drawings. Many others would not talk. Of the 20 or so witnesses she found, almost all of those who were closest (including a police officer, nine venture scouts and a government worker who said he "feared for his job" if he gave an interview) have remained silent.

Those who have described the events speak of a pink-orange ball which drifted toward the ground and exploded in a shower of purple sparks. Out of the shower came a white disc which appeared to land, out of sight, behind a ridge. The similarity with the controversial Larry Warren ("Art Wallace") story connected with Rendlesham Forest is certainly interesting. There is no doubt that most of these farmers had no knowledge of UFOs at all.

Superficially, it sounds like some sort of flare related to activity (the area is used for low-flying jet exercises). Indeed, at 6:26 A.M. the same night (Margaret Fry -- who lives four miles from the site -- knows full well; it woke her up!) a large army helicopter landed almost outside the front door of the police station and continued to ferry back and forth all morning to the remote hillside location. A couple of trucks also arrived that Sunday morning and dispatched a dozen troops south, toward the landing site, carrying backpacks.

Anyone who asked was told that the search operation was to find "something" that had been lost. Those more persistent were told it was "just flares." One farmer who lived by the site and lent a hand chatted with one soldier and asked what was really going on. He received the above answers, before pointing out that nobody mounts an operation like that for just a few spent flares. Why all the fuss? "It's what we've been asked to say" was the best response he got.

April 18, 1984 21.30 hrs.

Location: Lakenheath, Suffolk

Ninety-three hours later the military figured once again in a strange encounter. This happened on a road which passes right through the outer perimeter of the USAF/RAF base at Lakenheath in East Anglia. Lakenheath is famous in UFO annals as the host to the classic August 1956 radar-visual encounter which the Condon team failed to crack.

Mrs. SB was driving with her husband from their home (many miles away) to an Easter weekend visit with relatives. Mrs. SB, who is not interested in UFOs, is an intelligent young woman, aged 23, with a science degree. The couple were baffled by the strange thing they observed above the dark country lane.

It straddled the road and was the size of a football field. It was rectangular in shape and a mass of lights in long lines. She said that although she tried to count them it was impossible. There were at least 60. Red and green were at the edges but most were white. It was like a scene out of the movie *Close Encounters of the Third Kind*, she said.

The thing remained absolutely still, about 100 feet in the air, beside the road and adjacent (but not over) the base. At their closest approach there was not a trace of sound. A deer from the woodland beside the road seemed to be running away from where the object was.

When Mrs. SB contacted me (after picking up one of my books in an attempt to figure it out) we looked at possibilities. She is sure it could not have been a helicopter, because of its silence. Her husband, concentrating on driving and wanting to get to their destination after a long day, was less interested. They did not see it go. There was some talk of a giant floodlight, but when they returned in the light a few days later there was nothing but trees in the area, and no sign of anything that had recently been worked on. Lakenheath, of course, had no comment.

April 19, 1984 16.00 hrs.

Location: Eastern Airport, East Anglia

"Eastern Airport" is a pseudonym I am forced to use for the place in question, for reasons to be explained in a moment. It is a major civilian airport with full radar facilities. Its traffic load

is relatively light. The events (only hours after those referred to above) are geographically very close. Unfortunately, I cannot be more specific.

The witnesses are the three air traffic controllers who were on duty in the tower that day. They include A (senior controller who has been at the field since 1970), B (deputy controller, working the traffic at the time, a man with eight years' service at the airport), and Mrs. R (an assistant ATC with 12 years' service experience). The incident was reported by A to Peter Johnson, a veteran East Anglia-based BUFORA investigator who has often spoken with the control staff in the line of his work. Despite its being Easter weekend Johnson heard of the case almost immediately and was able to tape-record a detailed interview with A. The other witnesses preferred not to get involved but acknowledged the truth of the story.

It was a bright sunny day with no clouds below 5000 feet, a 15 kmph wind from the southwest and a visibility of 10 km. No major traffic was inbound or outbound, only a single light plane. In view of this and the good weather, the radar was temporarily switched off as it turned out, a most unfortunate circumstance.

A was sitting in on the proceedings, simply watching his two controllers at work. He heard the plane report turning onto "base leg," which meant it was lining up with the runway and just a few miles out. Idly looking across the patchy blue sky, he saw a brilliant white glow which he assumed was the aircraft reflecting the sun. It seemed to be lining up with the runway not in use. As he was puzzling this out, the aircraft radioed again to confirm he was lined up on the other runway, the one that was in use.

A informed his deputy controller that he had another plane coming in on the second runway. Both B and Mrs. R assured him, however, that this was not the case and got on with their work. A, wondering if he was watching a military plane from a nearby base, continued to look closely. But nothing was visible behind the glow.

Several seconds had passed since he first alerted B and Mrs. R and the object had now made a perfect approach to the cross runway. A grabbed his binoculars and quickly scanned the craft, which seemed to be landing. It was an

absolutely spherical object, which he describes as like "masses of silvery paper crinkled up." The amount of light reflected (or emitted) seemed out of proportion with the muted sun of the day. Now certain that it was displaying controlled flight, despite its small size (several feet in diameter only) and weird shape, A immediately called the attention of his colleagues. They had little time to worry about the possible conflict situation. The two runways intersected!

The UFO seemed to make a brief touchdown before "bouncing" off at a steep angle (at least 80 degrees) and rocketing skywards at considerable speed and in a maneuver thought impossible for an aircraft by all three observers. In less than a minute it had climbed to at least 3000 feet and was virtually out of sight.

Meanwhile the shaken controllers talked down the light plane, whose pilot made no reference to seeing the object. They thought it prudent not to enlighten the pilot while he was still off the ground!

As Mrs. R and B calmed each other down (the stress had particularly gotten to B) A made a routine call to the regional military command center to see if it had anything airborne. It confirmed not, adding that the normal radar surveillance by the base that covered the region was shut down 30 minutes before the sighting, because all traffic had landed and none was scheduled over the Easter weekend. A decided not to say anything about the reason for his inquiry.

After much discussion B and Mrs. R said they did not want to make a report. A scanned the Civil Aviation Log Book about the report of UFOs. There is a standard procedure to report to the Ministry of Defense (via West Drayton control near London). But they thought they spotted a loophole. As A later explained, "The manual said we were to report any UFOs that were reported to us. It did not say we should tell them about ones we saw ourselves!" Of course, they all realize this is a fairly liberal interpretation of the rules and technically they should have filed some kind of report. For this reason details of the names and the location cannot be published although BUFORA has them on file.

April 22, 1984 22.10 hrs.
Location: Saltfleet, Lincolnshire

As with the two previous sightings, this one occurred on the east coast of England. It has been subject to an intensive, ongoing investigation by the West Yorkshire UFO Group. I can present only a brief summary here.

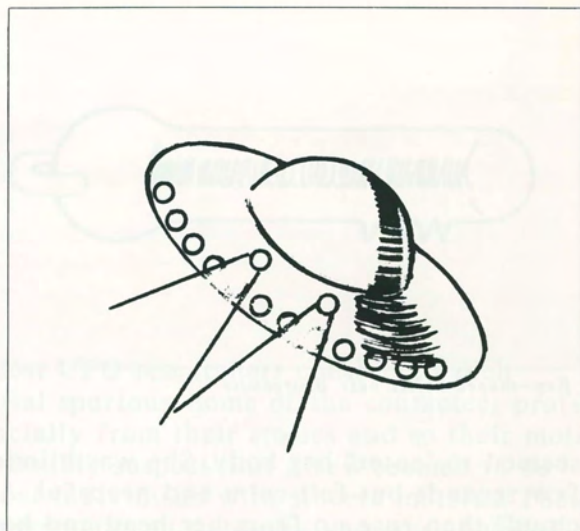
At a caravan site on this fairly remote part of the coast, 33-year-old Mrs. M (name on file) was watching television with her mother. Her two young boys were asleep in an adjacent trailer, but she heard them talking so she got up to settle them. On the way back to her film she saw a circle of white lights, a formation of smaller red lights above and a brilliant white light on top -- apparently on some dome-shaped object not far away.

She called out her mother and, by 22.17, both boys (aged 13 and 7). There was a definite oval shape with white, red green and blue lights in a circle, hovering about 500 feet up and near to the site. Then more lights came on and the entire thing began to revolve.

Lights once steady were now flashing, although this could have been an effect of the rotation. As the speed increased the colors blended into one another. The object now moved away due south.

Over the course of the next hour the object circled the caravan site in wide loops that took it several miles out to sea, before returning back right over their heads. As it flew toward the witnesses, it would switch on (and later switch off) a searchlight beam, which lit up the water, then the land below. As soon as it came on, several dogs in the area (previously undisturbed) began to bark madly. Also during the sighting Mrs. M went indoors to collect a coat because it was growing chilly. Her two dogs, trembling in fear, sat on the seat staring out through the closed curtains toward the object.

Back outside Mrs. M was looking at the object through binoculars when it came at them from the sea. It switched on the spotlight at this moment and she was blinded sufficiently to drop the field glasses. By the time she had recovered her sight, the object was almost on top of them. "Come on, you bastard, come closer and let us have a good



The Saltfleet UFO

look!" she was yelling up at it. It dropped to about 100 feet and hovered in absolute silence right over the heads of the four witnesses.

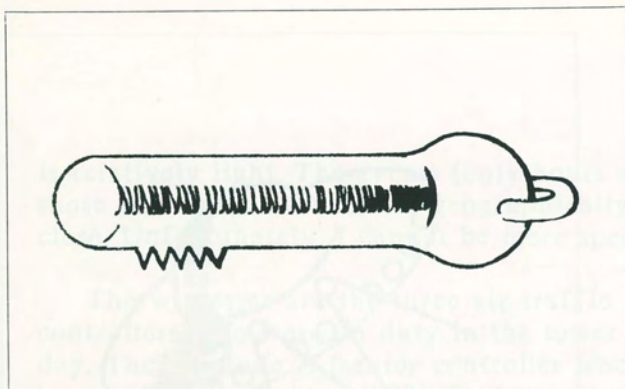
They could now see that the searchlight came from two "headlight" beams projecting forward. The craft had now tilted down slightly and the beam was illuminating the witnesses. After a few seconds it dimmed, giving them a spectacular view of the classic UFO shape, with a "smokey glass" dome on top. The rotating lights glowed with a fluorescent hazy appearance and as the object hovered for two minutes at a 45-degree tilt, the utter silence was in remarkable contrast to the howling of what seemed like every dog for miles about.

The UFO switched off all but four of its lights and climbed steeply in a vertical manner before heading out to sea to circle for a few more minutes. Meanwhile a couple who owned a beach bungalow arrived home with their baby. The infant was staring up at the UFO as if transfixed by it!

As you can see this is a potentially classic case and it is possible that much more will emerge as time goes by.

April 25, 1984 18.00 hrs.
Location: Blairgowrie, Scotland

A 59-year-old woman was in her garden doing a tapestry of the Madonna and child with her collie dog Shep by her side. The day had been warm but the evening air was cooling as the sun set. Her son was around the front of the house gardening. Suddenly Shep leaped up and fled indoors. A ball of light appeared in the air and



Key-shaped object over Blairgowrie

seemed to "enter" her body. She was blinded for a few seconds but felt calm and peaceful. A "white cloud" then rose up from her head and hovered over some bushes, where its light illuminated them. It "blinked" twice and climbed into the sky pointing out a large silvery object shaped like a house key. The cloud moved along the length of the key flashing and lighting up bits in turn.

After a few minutes the woman yelled to her son to come and look. He arrived just as the UFO swayed from side to side and vanished in a sudden pink flash. (Much like the pink flash at Llangernyw that began the wave 10 days before.) The son confirms this and says his mother was gazing at the sky "transfixed" when he approached. But he saw only the pink flash.

Summoned immediately, the police inspected the garden, took reports and filed these with the RAF base at Leuchars, on the east coast north of Edinburgh (not far from Blairgowrie). The police reported back to the family next day that neither they nor the RAF base had found any other witnesses and so they could do nothing further.

About a month later, according to both witnesses, an unmarked helicopter circled the garden five times at extremely low altitude. As it passed the trees where the silver-key UFO had been, it "tilted." Both side doors were open, and although no occupants were seen a "red glow" came from within. The son is convinced this glow was infrared and the result of RAF investigations of the landing site. He reported it to the local paper, but when reporters asked the police, they refused to comment. The paper did not pursue the story further, but two days later the helicopter flew over again, once and very briefly.

Steuart Campbell, who investigated the case for BUFORA, is no fan of "contact stories." In concluding, he asked simply "Hallucination?" A

fair point--were it not for the preceding cases in this extraordinary 10 days.

Conclusion

It should be evident that cases like these five do not happen every day. I am aware of no other reports, not even of lights in the sky, from the same time period. None of these made the newspapers at the time. Consequently they are certainly independent of one another.

One is tempted to wonder if the sightings were caused by massive military exercises. With no Freedom of Information Act in Britain, there is little chance of our ever proving that. (All my letters to the MOD on these and other cases, post Rendlesham Forest, have not even produced the courtesy of a reply, indicating that I am "persona non grata" in Whitehall.)

It is interesting that on at least two of the other five cycle dates there *were* military exercises. In the February 1979 events we have a statement, in response to parliamentary pressure, because one UFO nearly wrecked a caravan site that time. This statement admits that a "special" USAF exercise was in force during this period. But since some of the cases those 10 days include daylight landings of a nature very similar to the "Eastern airport" case, I am fairly confident that we *cannot* account for all these things as military activity.

Exercises surely do not follow 21-month cycles, in any case--unless, of course, the "special exercises" are responses to something else that does!

What next? I have noticed that not all of the cycle dates produce the same big number of reports. There tends to be a rise, but only every other cycle seems to be a real wave. January 1986 was the next prediction date (although as the cycle seems to waver between 21 and 22 months a one-month leeway is always needed). On December 28, 1985, there was a spectacular multiple encounter in the Pennines and Margaret Fry in Wales reported more sightings in January 1986 than for the whole of 1985. It is too early to tell yet, of course, but if the alternating pattern holds I would not expect anything like April 1984 to repeat this time.

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A night with lights

by Ann Druffel

Ann Druffel is coauthor, with D. Scott Rogo, of *The Tujunga Canyon Contacts* (1980).

A phenomenon which presents itself for the consideration of UFO researchers is "space channeling," during which purported UFO entities speak through psychic mediums, occasionally predicting appearances of anomalous nocturnal lights (NLs) and daylight discs (DDs). These alleged demonstrations of "Space Brothers" began in the late 1940s, paralleling the early years of the modern UFO wave, and continue unabated to the present time.

Serious UFO researchers have rejected demonstrations of "extraterrestrials" such as those coming from Dick T. Miller, a Los Angeles man who produced the "Monka tapes" as well as other communications from a second "entity" named Kla-la whose recorded messages could be purchased for \$4.50 each in 1959. (1)

The voice of Monka, reportedly received by radio transmission, was unconvincing, sounding much like Miller's own voice. The "space information" given was vague and sometimes naive, as was the information channeled through numerous mediums and channels during the ensuing years. (2) The "ET" messages were received in various ways, including automatic writing and trances. (3)

Invariably, the "space entities" seemed eager to inform, befriend and save the human race from its warlike pursuits and to prevent believers from being destroyed in a worldwide cataclysm. The "space information" received in various countries was similar in general content but specific details varied widely.

Many of these mediums stated that the world could not be saved from eventual destruction but that groups of human beings would be rescued by the intervention of the extraterrestrial craft. Those destined to survive were always the persons who believed in the truth of the mediums' space channeling. Needless to say, the predictions of disaster always failed to materialize. (4)

Most UFO researchers considered such material spurious. Some of the contactees profited financially from their stories and so their motives were doubly suspect. But a few seemed to be rational individuals with sincere motives. These persons sought no publicity and were puzzled by what was happening to them and some sought help from UFO investigators. Such individuals were termed "silent contactees" by the late Canadian researcher Wilbert B. Smith.

Encouraged by Smith's interest in these persons, I investigated a few southern California silent contactees firsthand in the 1960s and 1970s. Meanwhile, reports of channeling ETs have continued through the decades, sometimes surfacing from surprising sources. (5)

When a friend of mine, Jamie Sams, began channeling purported space entities in 1985, my interest was revived. Jamie, a rational and productive woman, believes herself to be clairvoyant. She says her family attempted to squelch her talents but upon attaining adulthood and financial independence, Jamie permitted herself to develop her psychic faculties.

In 1983 Jamie had two UFO sightings, in Altadena, California, (6) and in Hollywood. (7,8) Both were multiwitness events, reported through SKYNET channels. (9)

About a year ago Jamie began earning a modest living as a professional clairvoyant with clients on an individual basis as well as with groups. During one of Jamie's weekly classes personalities introducing themselves as space entities emerged and spoke through Jamie while she was in a state of fairly deep trance. In succeeding months they interacted with Jamie privately and also with the members of the weekly classes.

Jamie kept me informed about what was happening, stating that small anomalous lights -- presumed by her class to be UFOs -- had appeared

several times over her home following specific predictions by the space entities.

Understandably, conservative UFO journals are reluctant to publish material on space channeling. Claims about UFO sightings associated with channeling are typically dubious. For example, the sky watch classes regularly conducted by contactee Virgil Armstrong in the Los Angeles area and the channeling of the alleged entity "Seth" by Tom Massari (also of the Los Angeles area) have produced reports in which such conventional objects as high-flying aircraft, satellites and meteors were mistaken for UFOs.

When Jamie Sams presented me with a full-blown situation of purported ET channeling, however, it seemed worthwhile to investigate it, even though I had, and have, strong reservations about the empirical reality of channeled entities.

Up until November 1984, in fact, Jamie herself had wondered about her trances and tried objectively to judge whether the purported space entities were subconscious personalities or not. By the next month, after extended soul-searching, she became convinced that they were genuine.

What interested me about Jamie's channeling was her allegation that members of her class saw anomalous light phenomena after the channeled personalities predicted such lights would appear. Curious, I attended her class on December 18, 1984.

Two "personalities" named Leah and Ellsworth spoke through her, interacting with the members of the circle. Their voices, produced in fairly deep trance, were unlike Jamie's own. The timbre seemed the same but the speech patterns and accent were different. Some weeks before, the entities had predicted a worldwide cataclysm, to occur sometime in the late 1980s. Those of Jamie's group who were sufficiently spiritually evolved would be saved from the disasters, along with millions of other human beings who were similarly evolved. The survivors were to be lifted off the earth by spacecraft just before earth was to be "cleansed" and they would be put onto a new earth which would be, in essence, an astral counterpart of Terra.

To clarify this prediction of salvation from cataclysms, Leah has taught Jamie's group that

every living thing is an equal part of creation. Some human beings choose to seek the "Source" from which they came. Others choose service to self. Those who seek the Creator or God as a part of themselves will be saved from the alleged coming disasters and will return to the Source. The new earth, called "Akasha," exists on the "fourth dimension" and those who make the transition to Akasha will also make the transition to the fourth dimension, according to Leah.

During the December 18 class it was predicted that at 10 o'clock that evening our group would see a break in the thick clouds and within the cleared sky we would see lights which we would recognize as unconventional, i.e., as extraterrestrial.

At the stated time we stepped outdoors. The Los Angeles Basin had been pelted that day by a variety of meteorological wonders: a drenching cloudburst in Bellflower, several inches of sudden snow in the mountains, thunder, lightning and hail at selected areas as well as heavy rain over the entire Basin. That evening it was still raining lightly and the sky all over the Hollywood area and other parts of southern California was covered with a heavy, low-altitude layer of rainclouds.

As I viewed the sky, I doubted that any break in the thick cloud layer could suddenly occur. After about a minute I realized that the thick cloud layer was moving briskly from southeast to northwest. Later, a study of weather information revealed that this wind direction, uncommon to the Basin, was due to turbulent air masses proceeding out of Mexico.

The thick cloud layer seemed to have abruptly displayed rapid movement. Suddenly, in the east, between 20-25 degrees elevation, a clear break occurred. It was 5-10 degrees across, raggedly oval in shape. The time was 10:03. Within the break there was absolutely no evidence of stars. The sky background in the break was dark gray; apparently another higher layer of clouds was obscuring our view of the upper sky.

Suddenly, in the midsection of the break, a very small white light started winking irregularly against the gray background. It seemed about magnitude 4 or 5, but because of its brief period I cannot be precise. Winking repeatedly, it

displayed a lateral northward motion. Its angular speed was roughly one-half degree between flashes.

The light seemed to be moving too fast to be an aircraft. If it were an aircraft, it would have had to be flying very high for a strobe light to appear so tiny; at such a high altitude even a fast jet should have displayed a slower angular velocity. Still, the light possibly was a strobe light on a very high-flying plane but the flashes did not seem regular enough or rapid enough to confirm this. The group watched the light carefully as it proceeded toward the north, maintaining a horizontal path.

The light was tiny and Jamie pointed it out to some group members who did not immediately see it, calling off the pulses she saw it emitting. I could not see all the flashes she counted off, despite good far eyesight. But no matter, for before the first light disappeared due north, still traveling within its moving break in the clouds, another break in the clouds appeared at 20-25 degrees elevation in the east and another tiny light, identical to the first, appeared within it.

This second light traveled along the same path as the first, within another roughly oval, ragged break in the clouds. Its period of pulse was irregular also, at least to my vision, but Jamie counted a more or less regular rhythm which seemed about twice as slow as the normal period of the flashing of an aircraft strobe light.

In all, five or six successive breaks in the clouds appeared between 10:03 and 10:09, each raggedly oval and each with an identical tiny white light flashing within it. At about 10:10 Jamie decided the phenomenon was over and the damp group tramped back into the house. I stayed behind in the yard a minute or two, watching a last small break in the clouds move north, but no light was within it. The breaks in the clouds came to an end with the passage of this last small opening. The clouds closed up as thick as before.

Jamie's group accepted the happening as a fulfillment of Leah's prediction of extraterrestrial craft. I was left with a sense that something unusual had occurred but the lights were too small to be regarded as meaningful NLs.

Over the next few days, however, I puzzled over the possible identity of the flashing lights. Although they were not readily identifiable as strobe lights on high-flying planes, the irregularity and/or longer pulse period might have been occasioned by aircraft traveling near the lower edge of the second cloud layer, so that some of the strobe-light pulses were concealed from sight behind the lower edge of the upper cloud layer. This seemed an acceptable explanation of the lights, although the fact that the phenomenon occurred precisely at the time predicted, within totally unexpected breaks in the clouds, remained unexplained.

In order to test my hypothesis that the lights were caused by strobe lights on high-flying aircraft, perhaps flying on an established flight path, I went back to Jamie's house on January 15, 1985, equipped with high-powered binoculars and other measuring equipment. From 9:55 to 10:15 P.M. I watched the skies east, north and south of her home through 7x35 Bushnell binoculars, at an elevation between 15 and 30 degrees, hoping to find some evidence that that area of sky was part of a regular flight path for high-flying planes. The skies that evening were cloudless.

There was no evidence of any high-flying aircraft and no evidence that the areas of sky concerned were part of any regular flight path. During the 20 minutes I scanned the sky, only one plane was seen -- a small, low-flying private aircraft with normal lighting.

Although this investigation was not conclusive, it left open the possibility that the lights seen on December 18 may have been anomalous. Consider the following:

(a) Five or six lights, each identical in appearance, passed along identical flight paths within a matter of six minutes.

(b) Each successive light traveled within totally unexpected breaks in a thick raincloud layer.

(c) Each light maintained a steady course in the center of each break and moved precisely with the motion of the breaks over an angular distance of at least 90 degrees.

(d) Each cloud break maintained its raggedly oval shape over the entire course.

Of course the possibility that the lights were unscheduled (military?) aircraft, and that the breaks in the clouds were wholly coincidental, cannot be ignored. Thus while it was not conclusive of UFO activity, I considered this incident worth reporting because the unexpected lights were seen at the precise time predicted by space channeling.

I discussed the incident with a group of professionals engaged in applied parapsychological research in Los Angeles. It was their view, with which I concurred, that the space channeling does not constitute scientific evidence that the "personalities" apparently channeled are extraterrestrial in nature. Before the advent of the modern period of UFO sightings, "entities" channeled through trance mediums often introduced themselves as red Indians (native Americans), Tibetans, ancient Egyptians, Atlanteans and other cultures which purportedly strove to achieve spiritual enlightenment.

With the advent of the modern UFO Age, Egyptians and Tibetans were supplanted by "extraterrestrials" -- another group which could logically represent expanded knowledge. This suggests that the phenomenon of channeling originates in the mediums' own minds and reflects images from popular culture.

I then presented the situation to a small group of Los Angeles UFO researchers, including physicists, engineers and medical doctors. I extended an invitation from Jamie to attend her class perhaps with a chance of viewing the lights themselves. Although not all were able to accept, they considered the situation worthy of their attention.

On February 15, 1985, four members of the research group, an applied physicist, an experimental physicist, an engineer and I, gathered in Jamie's home. Also present was another UFO investigator who is a retired policeman as well as two members of Jamie's regular circle.

That evening Leah came through and held an extended conversation with the visiting investigators, answering questions about Leah's

home planet, ET physics, the nature of the atom, and other matters. Although the questions were phrased politely, it was clear that the scientifically-trained members of the UFO research group were testing Leah's (or Jamie's) knowledge of exobiology and physics. Leah answered all questions put to her, at length. Later, Jamie remarked that, if some of the answers seemed erroneous (as the experimental physicist thought) or in other ways less than satisfactory, this was because Leah was a healer (on her planet) rather than a scientist. Despite the length at which she spoke, Leah seemed unfamiliar with advanced (earth) physics nomenclature.

During this trance Leah made no prediction of any lights for that night. As Jamie awakened, she was told that the engineer in the group would have to leave early because of another appointment. Jamie quickly tried to perceive psychically if anomalous lights would show up that night so that the engineer could participate in the viewing. She predicted that the lights would appear at 9:37. A minute or two before the predicted time, everyone trooped outdoors and stood for 10 or 15 minutes watching in various sectors of the sky, since Jamie was not sure just where the sighting would occur.

As the minutes ticked by, nothing unusual appeared. Jamie wandered to the west side of the house and presently called us over to view what she thought was an anomalous light. It turned out to be the strobe light on a distant plane. The two members of her class, after intently observing a source of light at the zenith, claimed it was moving in slight zigzag or circular patterns. This "light" was recognized as a normal star and later positively identified as Procyon. The apparent motion described was caused by involuntary eye movement.

Jamie continued with another trance session. Leah was asked why Jamie's prediction of lights at 9:37 was not fulfilled. Leah asserted that the correct time had been given but Jamie "was not paying attention when we expressed the fact that the sighting should be due east. She was so nervous about this particular gathering that in her haste she did not listen further, nor did she go within to allow us to express ourselves further." (10)

Leah requested our understanding on this matter and invited us back at some future date when there would be "another opportunity, if you choose. We will show ourselves at another time."

Despite the failure of the space channeling to produce predictive results that night, Jamie's two class members were not disappointed. They described other evenings when unusual lights which they insisted were unconventional in nature had appeared, apparently fulfilling trance predictions.

Sometime later I talked with Jamie about the events of that evening. She said the failed prediction was an error having to do with her own intense desire to have phenomena manifest to the UFO researchers. She also claimed that the presence of the experimental physicist, an avowed skeptic of the paranormal, had prevented the group from acting as a cohesive whole to help bring about a predicted "night light" event. She contended that the "negative vibrations" had upset her.

At future meetings of our research group, we reviewed the events of December 18. The majority held that nothing had been established. Leah's assertions about atomic structure, extraterrestrial physics and so on were judged meaningless because her answers to such questions involved terms and ideas that did not fit into our ordinary understanding of matter and energy. A future meeting with Jamie is planned to explore the prospect of mutually-understandable nomenclature and to have another chance of viewing possibly anomalous lights.

In summary, what is the significance of the space-channeling phenomenon in UFO research? Many groups are caught up in it all over the world. Its existence should be recognized. It deserves investigation by interested persons, if only to establish that it has no real connection with the UFO phenomenon as it is normally understood. But sometimes, as in Jamie Sams' case, the trance phenomenon is followed by (possibly) anomalous sky phenomena -- raising interesting questions which perhaps can be resolved with the application of proper scientific study.

Notes

1. The local press covered these events generously, and mostly humorously. Kla-la's tapes were mentioned in the *Los Angeles Times*, July 12, 1959, "2000 Flying Saucer Converts Discuss Space."
2. For example, *UFOs -- Keys to Earth's Destiny*, Guardian Action Publications, circa 1980, reportedly channeled through Winfield Brownell.
3. For example, *Why We Are Here* by Gloria Lee (channeling J.W. of Jupiter), Los Angeles, DeVorss & Co., Publishers.
4. For a sociological study of one such group, see *When Prophecy Fails* by Leon Festinger, Henry W. Riecken and Stanley Schachter, Minneapolis, University of Minnesota Press, 1956.
5. Other researchers were also investigating these silent contactees, including several employed by the United States government. See *The UFO Controversy in America* (1975) by David Michael Jacobs, page 173.
6. This DD case occurred on June 16, 1983, between 7:00 and 8:00 P.M. A multitude of tiny white lights were observed by three adult witnesses in the yard of a private home at the same time a disc-shaped object half the apparent size of the full moon was viewed moving in and out of a small cloud in the sky. Flashes of light were also seen coming from the direction of the cloud. Case in SKYNET files.
7. On July 1, 1983, at about 10:00 P.M. multiple witnesses viewed a stationary whitish light about magnitude 1 at 45 degrees elevation in the east. Multiple witnesses at two different locations in Hollywood also viewed numerous smaller red lights in the same general vicinity of the object. The primary object could not be identified as a star or planet.
8. This occurrence closely matched (in location, direction and duration) a prediction by Hollywood clairvoyant Hamilton Farmer that a UFO would appear high over the Los Angeles area on that date and time and would be viewed by persons attending the 1983 MUFON symposium in Pasadena. The object was predicted to be "Saturn-shaped and approximating the size of the full moon."

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UFOs and ufologists in Poland

by Bronislaw Rzepecki

Bronislaw Rzepecki is coordinator of the UFO Research Group of Cracow.

Although the UFO era began on June 24, 1947, with Kenneth Arnold's famous sighting of unknown aerial phenomena, and the first ufological organizations followed not long after, ufology did not come to Poland until the late 1970s.

As early as 1958, however, there had been some attempt to interest Poles in the UFO phenomenon. That year, in the magazines *Wieczor Wybrzeza* and *Skrzydlatą Polską*, writer Andrzej Trepka addressed the subject in a thoughtful, serious way and in so doing laid the groundwork for the Polish ufological movement which would come later. In 1961 the first Polish book about UFOs, Janusz Thor's *Latające Talerze* (*Flying Saucers*), appeared.

By the early 1970s many leading Polish journalists, among them Lucjan Znicz, Andrzej Donimirski, Arnold Mostowicz and Zbigniew Blania, were writing popular articles about UFOs, recounting sightings and speculating about their nature, origin and propulsion. These were based mostly on material from Western sources. At the same time UFO hobbyists started to meet informally in private homes to discuss their subject and exchange information.

In 1976 the weekly *Fakty* ran a series of UFO articles, "The Guests From Space," by Lucjan Znicz, and sparked a great deal of interest. Many readers entered into correspondence with Znicz and out of this exchange came the idea of establishing a UFO club.

On July 8, 1978, the Polish ufological movement came into being with the formation of Klub Kontaktów Kosmicznych (Space Contacts Club) which brought together persons interested in UFOs from all parts of the nation. The organization still exists. The following December the short-lived UFO-Sonda was organized in Wrocław.

But the first legally-registered UFO organization, formed on June 24, 1981, was the Varsovian UFO Research Society (also known as "UFO-Video"), led then (as now) by Janusz Marczak. The first UFO bulletin in Polish, however, appeared in November 1981, the product of the Ufological Section of the Cracovian Science Fiction Fan Club, formed in January 1980. The bulletin was titled *Wizje Peryferyjne* (*Peripheral Visions*). In January 1983 the organization split from the science-fiction group and established its independent existence as the Cracovian Club of UFO Research and Popularization. I founded the Ufological Section and was chairman of the Cracovian Club.

In Łódź in February 1983 the Space Club of Łódź ("Para-UFO") was formed.

Nineteen eighty-three was a milestone in the Polish ufological movement. In February representatives of the Space Contacts Club, UFO-Video, Para-UFO and the Cracovian Club met to discuss mutual cooperation and future directions. It was decided that the Cracovian Club would organize new groups in other Polish cities. The ufologists also agreed on investigative procedures and standards and laid plans for a Polish Ufological Congress.

That Congress was held in Cracow between September 23 and 25, 1983. Participants included representatives of the above-mentioned organizations as well as new ones in Szczecin, Lublin, Gdańsk, Rzeszów and other cities. The next Congress took place in Szczecin in November 1984. The most recent, in September 1985, was in Lublin.

The second legally-authorized ufological organization was the Cracovian UFO Research Society, a continuation of the Cracovian Club. I was elected chairman. Unfortunately the organization did not last long. Born in January 1984, it died in October 1985. On October 29 a nonformal UFO Research Group (Box 71, 30-529 Cracow-14) replaced it, under my direction.

I should mention that Poland also has individuals and groups that have nothing to do with serious ufology. Still, these persons call themselves "ufologists," give interviews to the mass media and publish their "research." Their ridiculous claims give serious working ufologists a bad name because the media do not differentiate the pseudoufologists from the sober investigators.

Although the Polish ufological movement is a recent development, observations of UFOs have been around for a long time. Because no one was actively documenting them before 1978, our records are incomplete and the cases uninvestigated. There are, for example, 16th and 17th Century reports of what may have been UFOs, but we simply do not have enough information to make a really informed judgment on what the phenomena in question were.

This is true as well of a number of 20th Century observations. But we do know a little bit more about them. Some of the more interesting ones follow:

Zalesie, June 22, 1908. Four witnesses watched a bright yellow object flying overhead.

Warsaw, Summer 1922. Many witnesses saw a silvery object, shaped like two hemispheres divided by a rotating ring. The object shot a beam of light, then ascended with a loud noise.

Wolin Island (on the Baltic Sea), July 31, 1953. At 7:00 P.M., near a railroad track, five Poles and two Germans observed the landing of a disc-shaped object, about 22 meters in diameter. After several minutes the object rose and flew away at great speed.

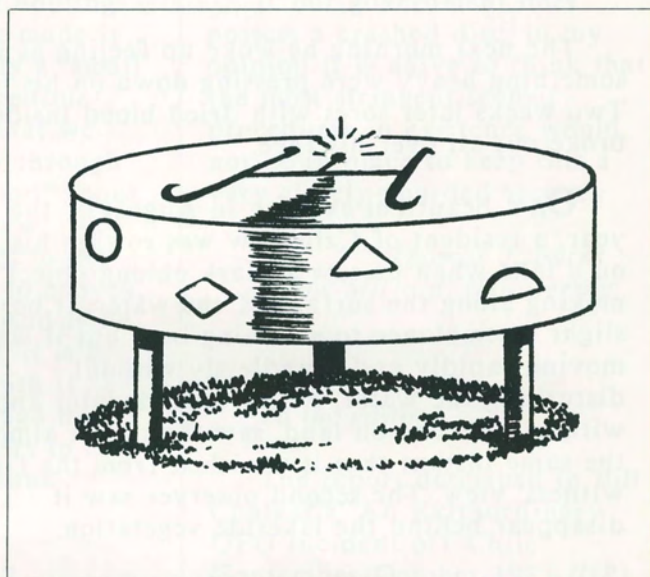
Muszyna, December 22, 1958. A physician named Kowalczewski took the first Polish photograph of a UFO -- a dark, disc-shaped object seen at three o'clock in the afternoon.

Kolobrzeg, March 1959. As soldiers watched, a triangle-shaped object rose from the sea, near the coast, and circled above the wavy surface of the water. The UFO, about four meters long on each side, accelerated and vanished.

According to rumor, on January 21 of the same year, a UFO catastrophe occurred in Gdynia, where a burned and injured humanoid

being in a spacesuit was found. He was taken to a hospital and died there. Arthur Shuttlewood mentions the story in his book *The Flying Saucerers* but we have been unable to find any reason to believe this extraordinary event occurred.

The incidents described above are all imperfectly documented. I mention them only to demonstrate that alleged UFO phenomena were being reported (though not investigated) prior to the onset of UFO research in Poland. Since 1978 we have a great many sightings which we have investigated and documented. I shall recount two of them, one a close encounter of the second kind, the other a CE3:



Waldemar R.'s floating "hockey puck"

On May 22, 1979, Waldemar R. left his home intending to go to a cafe situated in a park in Piastow, near Warsaw. The evening being cold, he walked briskly, arriving at the park around 10 P.M. He noticed a strange and total silence around him; then, about five meters away, he saw two bright yellow beams of light. As he looked closer, he determined that they were on the bottom of a dark object floating just above the ground.

Under the silhouette of the three-meter-wide object, which was shaped like a hockey puck, he could see a third beam of light. Without knowing why, the witness approached the object, then stopped about three meters from it. At that point all along the side of the UFO green geometrical

shapes -- triangles, squares, trapezoids and circles -- appeared and vanished.

Then, on the upper surface of the object, a red light shone, illuminating an H-shaped sign which occupied almost all the available space. A vertical bar was connected to the horizontal bar that linked the two "legs" of the H; at the tip of this a red light blinked on and off.

Suddenly the entire object shone with a white-blue light and a barely visible aura of light outlined the UFO. The witness' face felt as if it were burning and, badly frightened, he turned away, ran and did not look back. He went straight home.

The next morning he woke up feeling as if something heavy were pressing down on his head. Two weeks later sores with dried blood inside broke out all over his face.

On a beautiful evening in August of the same year, a resident of Człuchów was rowing his boat on a lake when he saw a "dark oblong object" moving along the surface of the water. It bore a slight resemblance to a fishing boat but it was moving rapidly and soundlessly without disturbing the water. A few seconds later another witness, this one on land, saw the object almost in the same instant that it vanished from the first witness' view. The second observer saw it disappear behind the lakeside vegetation.

He called his dogs and with them went to the spot where he thought the "boat" would be landing. He had walked about 20 steps when he sighted, 20 meters from the shore, two beings in dark suits. They were heading toward the forest. When the dogs ran in their direction, the strangers turned around and looked at them. The dogs stopped in their tracks, barked and retreated in terror.

The strangers resumed their trek and over the next moments the witness studied them carefully. One and a half meters tall, they were sealed in what resembled diving outfits. At the level of their eyes was a "glass plate" through which they could see. Their hips were unnaturally wide and each had a "hump" between the back of his neck and his shoulders.

The witness shouted at them to stop, but on hearing his voice, they fled into the trees. As the man was searching for them, a brightly luminous object floated up above the tree tops 100 meters away. The object, rectangular-shaped with rounded corners, stopped its ascent about 30 meters above the ground. The light along its sides was blue-green but this color shaded off into white in the middle of the object.

The UFO flew away, leaving no traces where the witness estimated it would have been "parked." Nor could he find the footprints of its presumed occupants.

The witness claimed that, in the six months following the incident, the dogs' front legs became paralyzed and both of the animals had to be destroyed.

So you see that the UFO phenomenon is not confined to the United States, Latin America or Western Europe. It is known to us in Eastern Europe as well. The observations and investigations here are as interesting as they are elsewhere in the world. UFOs, it is clear, do not recognize national boundaries.

Dr. Hynek dies

As this issue of *IUR* was going to press, we were saddened to learn of Dr. Hynek's death on April 27, in the Scottsdale, Arizona, Memorial Hospital. Cause of death was a malignant brain tumor.

Although we at CUFOS knew of the gravity of his illness, his passing still came as a shock to all of us. An era of UFO history has ended and a new one has begun.

In accordance with Dr. Hynek's wishes, on May 3 the Board of Directors elected Mark Rodeghier Scientific Director of CUFOS.

The next issue of *IUR* will be devoted entirely to an appreciation of Dr. Hynek and his achievements.

Letters

To the editor:

Todd Zechel's letter (*IUR*, November/December 1985) commenting on my article "Crashed Discs -- Maybe" (*IUR*, July/August 1985) disputes my account of the interview we had with the Army officer and the crashed-disc report I listed as "1953: near White Sands, New Mexico."

I regret that one of us has a faulty memory. This disagreement, of course, compromises the case. Since the interview took place nearly 10 years ago, I am so far unable to locate my notes. A review of the correspondence from the original source and of secondary communications in my files suggests, however, that Zechel may be confusing two different stories attributed to the officer. Either that, or we heard very differently what the man said.

At the meeting we both attended, Zechel's major (my lieutenant-colonel) most definitely did *not* "recant" the 1953 firsthand witness, personal involvement story first told to us by one of his former students. Neither did he strongly affirm it, but by implication he let it stand as valid. (What he may have told Zechel later or on camera for the Nippon-TV documentary is another question.) Both the first- and secondhand crashed-disc stories were cited by the original source and I recall that both were discussed, somewhat

obliquely on his part, at the meeting in question. As I reported, he was not (then) a cooperative witness. But he never said any words amounting to a denial.

We would all like to have "one reasonably airtight, checkable case. . . that might stand up under critical scrutiny," but I'm not holding my breath. My article made it clear that there is only a "small body" of seemingly credible crashed-disc reports that we should "carefully sort through" and "keep an open mind" about while watching for new evidence. If he objects to the message I was trying to convey, that is his privilege. And if he has the One Big Case, it is his duty to come forth with it rather than to disparage the honest efforts of others to call attention to a portentous question.

Richard Hall
Brentwood, Maryland

To the editor:

David M. Jacobs writes ("Crashed Discs -- No," July/August 1985 *IUR*) that the problem of a crashed disc is not the same as a UFO problem. "A crashed and recovered object is a 'provable' situation," he says. "Produce the UFO or pieces of it: anything short of that will not do."

But isn't that what the scientific establishment has been saying all along regarding *UFOs in general*? Does lack of hard evidence of crashed discs constitute proof of nonexistence any more than the lack of same for the UFO phenomenon in general constitutes proof of its nonexistence?

If our government does possess a crashed disc, in my opinion it is naive to think that the most stringent security procedures in existence would not be in place to keep this a very closely-guarded secret.

Thomas J. Burns
New Milford, New Jersey

To the editor:

The report described in Bill Chalker's "An Extraordinary UFO Incident off Chile" (September/October 1985 *IUR*) requires no further investigation. It is an interesting story but a pure fabrication.

The detection of the phenomena at 400 miles, as the story would have it, is a spectacular accomplishment even for today's ship radar, not to mention the radar available to Chilean Naval vessels in 1969. Moreover, even if the objects were egg-shaped, they would not appear on radar as "egg-shaped images."

We are asked to believe that the captain apparently knew

what the objects were. Then American investigators were called in not to obtain information but to persuade the witnesses that they hadn't seen what they saw, even threatening them with death if they talked about the event.

The Chilean Navy is small and paranoid about letting outsiders know what is going on within it. A destroyer's crew is even smaller, a family group, and one family member should have no trouble tracing his crewmates down, whatever else the story would have you believe.

*Alvin G. McNish
Rockville, Maryland*

To the editor:

Do we, as Jerome Clark suggests (September/October 1985 *IUR* editorial), want to believe in the UFO as an alien artifact? I believe the answer is yes. Do we want to believe in the UFO as a natural physical phenomenon or electromagnetic effect in our electro-magnetohydrosphere? No.

The Greeks, who did not understand the nature of ordinary lightning, invented an alien (Zeus) to account for it. A few centuries later we wish to invent another alien to account for what may well be just another natural electromagnetic effect. Like the ancients we don't know the precise causation

of that effect but unlike them we have a clue: Whatever the causation is, it must have especially prevailed during the period 1946 through 1969 to account for the extraordinary parade of UFO sighting report waves of that unique period.

In my view, like the Greeks we want to believe in the UFO as an alien artifact, for three reasons:

First, like the Greeks, we want to explain the UFO as easily as possible.

Second, we subconsciously resent the intrusion of science into every aspect of our thinking, science that rends apart our poetic sensibilities, religions and mythologies, making our universe too mechanical and comprehensible, marooning all our mysteries. The UFO organizations attract individuals who are stricken with a romantic fallacy, science-fictionists and dreamers intent upon holding on to comforting unreality.

Third, having invented the alien, we anticipate from him a quantum leap in our circumstances from his benevolence in extending to us all his incredibly advanced science, a science which may banish forever all our poverty, wars, crimes, inconveniences and miseries, creating for us a new world: the old messianic fallacy which always rears its head in times of special

puzzlement and social difficulty.

I believe we will never deal successfully with the UFO as long as we allow these fallacies to stand constantly between us and the physics of the phenomenon: our chief objective.

*Mel Davis
Anacortes, Washington*

To the editor:

In "Secret Language of UFO Abductions -- A Speculation" (July/August 1985 *IUR*) D. Scott Rogo suggests that some UFO abduction reports are "a dramatized encapsulation of the witness' own mental concerns, with the goal to bring the conflict to conscious attention."

I wonder if we can project this hypothesis on a much larger screen, seeing if major conflicts or tensions within society at large generate UFO flaps.

Although I found Rogo's article quite refreshing, I am unconvinced by his further speculation the "perhaps some 'x' intelligence symbiotically linked to life on this planet and to our minds sends the UFO phenomenon to us."

*Tim T. Tokaryk
Regina, Saskatchewan
Canada*

To the editor:

I disagree with D. Scott Rogo's reply to my letter to the editor (September/October 1985 *IUR*). If two values, 1,000,000,000,000,000 and 1,000,000,000,000,001, are compared to two other values, -1,000,000,000,000,000 and -1,000,000,000,000,001, statistical tests could give a P value astronomically less than 0.05. The P value wouldn't allow one to conclude that the sample size is too small or that the data are bad or have been misused. Also, a sample size is not too small because the statistics are not significant. There are methods to determine if a sample size is too small. If Rogo had applied them to Alvin Lawson's data, his article ("Birth Traumas from Outer Space," May/June 1985 *IUR*) might have been a stronger criticism.

I. Scott
Ohio State University
Columbus

To the editor:

An error crept into the biographical note that appeared with my article "An Analysis of the Rendlesham Forest Tape" (*IUR*, November/December 1985). I am *not* "retired." I go to work every day to put the bacon on the table.

I believe this misimpression probably resulted from a poor choice of words on my part. In

reviewing my background for John Timmerman, I may have carelessly said that I "retired from broadcasting" in 1969, when I should have said left, deserted, forsook or something similar. I changed careers at that time. I did, however, maintain a part-time and occasional involvement in broadcasting up through 1985.

Robert H. Coddington
Richmond, Virginia

We apologize for the error. -- The Editor

To the editor:

The editorials by Richard Hall, Jerome Clark and Mark Rodeghier in the November/December issue of *IUR* were outstanding. They make one proud to be a member of CUFOS. With reason and fairness as operating principles, with respect for the intelligence and motives of the opposition, with patient, ongoing dialogue, there is always hope for the emergence of truth and better understanding.

William T. Sherwood
Rochester, New York

UFO story crashes to earth...

CUFOS' investigation of the alleged 1884 UFO crash near Benkelman, Nebraska (*IUR*, September/October 1985, page 18), has determined -- perhaps not surprisingly -- that the story was a hoax engineered by an imaginative 19th-Century journalist.

Anatomy of a UFO wave

continued from page 8

After that, however, we move to September and October 1987. The alleged "10 year cycle" has produced major British waves in 1957, 1967 and 1977. So ufologists in Europe have long predicted a 1987 wave. That my cycle coincides and offers a more precise dating is most interesting.

A night with lights

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These last two aspects of the prediction were not fulfilled. See my article "California Report," *MUFON UFO Journal*, June 1983.

9. SKYNET is a filter center and tracking system active in the Los Angeles Basin area. It gleans UFO reports from the Griffith Observatory, a federal agency telephone number, public libraries and other sources.

10. Phrases in quotes have been taken verbatim from a tape recording of the trance sessions.

Coming soon in *IUR*...

J. Allen Hynek and the UFO phenomenon,
by David M. Jacobs

Prince Charles and the UFO that never was,
by Jenny Randles

Mysteries over Virginia,
by Robert D. Boyd

The shadow

A great modern poet has written, "Between the conception and the reality falls the shadow."

We moderns understand that primitive man reported regularly as observed fact many wish-fulfillment fantasies or "miracles" which we know could not have been. Most of us, and particularly scientists, relegate such affairs to the limbo of "mythology." The sense of reality of modern man differs essentially from that of primitive man. We no longer accept revelation as a good interpretation of reality, our sense of which is grounded chiefly in science. But a survey of people today would probably demonstrate that the "moderns" among us are relatively few.

How can the UFO investigator determine whether a particular UFO reporter is "modern" or "primitive" in his sense of reality? In a particular report, does the "shadow" fall between the observed reality of the eye and the reported reality of the brain? I believe we must acknowledge that it often does, that a reporter, observing a gaseous plasma (a true UFO), may structure it in his brain until it becomes a metallic spacecraft. Moreover, he may, to make his artistry more plausible, add a primate alien as "observed fact." But he can't offer it as "observable fact," a very important distinction.

Every reporter of a UFO becomes in a sense an artist, since art is essentially communication. For most scientists, that art is expressed in the effort to report the object as realistically as possible, but most UFO reporters, who are not scientists, may bend or alter the image of the observed fact of the eye to quite another object indeed. A reporter is not concerned primarily with a scientific sense of reality, and the "shadow" falls often.

For example, ancient Ezekiel reported quite accurately various aspects of the UFO ("cloud cigar") he observed but he also went on to add many aspects -- cherubims, for one -- which derived from his primary occupation as prophet. We assume from his description that (1) the object was gaseous in form ("cloud"); (2) it was swirling ("whirlwind"); (3) it was at least 30 meters in diameter ("great cloud"), which is a standard description of the modern "cloud cigar"; (4) it was discoid in shape ("wheel"); (5) it was ionized and

engaged in deionization ("lightning"); (6) it showed flame spectra colors ("amber" and "beryl"). It's a good objective image of the anomaly that I suspect may be behind the UFO phenomenon in general. I assume that the object derived from some severe volcanic explosion.

If such a "shadow" does fall indeed between the observed fact and the reported fact, we would expect different observers (different artists) to show individual artistic differences, just as Van Gogh differs markedly from El Greco in his art. We should expect these differences to show in (1) structure of the supposed alien artifact or spacecraft and (2) the appearance and size of the supposed accompanying alien primate.

In fact, this is precisely what we do find. No two sketches of the reported craft are alike. The same is true of sketches of aliens, except that the eyes generally resemble the demon archetype of Prof. C. G. Jung, with sinister eyefold and grim or frightening expression.

These facts have of course long been noted by scientists, most of whom are not primitives but moderns in their sense of reality, and most of them consequently smile and exclaim, "What a coincidence! The aliens are primates like us!"

Unfortunately they are inclined often to go a mile farther and dismiss the whole UFO anomaly (or natural plasma phenomenon) as another artistic mythological product, especially if they are persuaded by debunker "detectives" who report only their successes and never their failures or who consider only those cases in which, owing to UFO investigators' naivete or incompetence, flaws are easy to find.

The "observed fact" as often presented by UFO reporters cannot be trusted as valid evidence. We must insist, for such evidence, on "observable fact." Does such an "observable fact" really exist?

Yes, there is one "observable fact": a close correlation between sighting-report waves and severe volcanic explosions of the past hundred years, an easily "observable fact" which continues eternally to remain "observable" to any ufologist who wishes to observe it. This single leg constitutes our unique and singular evidence of the existence and causation of that plasma-gaseous natural anomaly called the "UFO." -- Mel Davis